

CIRCLES

Comedy

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2024

FADE IN:

1. INT. BEDROOM - MORNING

JAMES (20) wakes up in his bed to start the day. He scans his ROOM, almost admiring how it looks.

His bedroom looks spotless. Everything is in its place and clean; shoes are arranged in particular ways according to color, folders and papers are sitting nicely on his desk by his bed with accessories having their own space on the table.

James stretches, thankful for the day, and hops up. He goes to his closet to throw on some slippers with his morning routine in hand; toothbrush, toothpaste, and facial products.

CUT TO:

2. INT. BATHROOM - MOMENTS LATER

James enters the bathroom gently and begins to set his things down on the counter, aligning them in a STRAIGHT LINE. He starts with his face products, wetting and washing his face. We spend that time with him and experience how calm he lives his life. Later, he brushes his teeth. Suddenly his phone rings.

CUT TO:

MEDIUM SHOT OF JAMES

MACIE (VOICE OVER)

Hey! It's me. How are you?

JAMES

(toothbrush in his mouth)

I'm doing great! It's good to hear your voice. What's up?

MACIE

(blushingly)

I'm doing good too. Remember our plans right? We were gonna go out to that new coffee place, right?

JAMES

(spits, then lays his toothbrush down)

Oh, yeah! What time did you wanna meet?

MACIE

How does later this afternoon sound?

JAMES
Sounds great. I'll see you then!

James hangs up the phone.

3. INT. BEDROOM - LATER

James enters his bedroom to eagerly set his stuff down where THEY BELONG. Excitement beaming through him, he finds his outfit for the day. James finishes getting ready and we spend a moment with him as he checks his hair and outfit one last time. Suddenly, he is struggling to find his keys. There is a shift in the room.

JAMES
(confused)
Wasn't it sitting on my coffee
table? What in the world? My keys
are always right here...

James glances around his room with a concerned look on his face. He feels as if his whole life is destroyed now that one item in his room is out of place. It seems as if the whole world is crashing down on him. His OCD is overwhelming him in this moment. James looks distraught. There is a moment where he is doubting himself as well as his organization skills.

He starts to panic.

JAMES
(confused, almost baffled)
I know they're around here
somewhere.

James starts to freak out a bit more as he is never this clumsy with his things. This moment is life or death for him because he is also worried about the time, and the potential of being late to see Macie.

James holds his head with his hands and starts to breathe heavily with a quicker pace. He CLOSES HIS EYES for a beat.

Once he opens his eyes again, he glances back at a spot in his room where a BAG had been left hanging by the door. An idea is brought up in his mind. He feels relieved that there may still be some hope for the day.

James gets back up off of the floor and walks towards the bag.

CUT TO:

LOW ANGLE SHOT OF THE BAG (LEFT) AND JAMES (RIGHT)

JAMES
(in his head, whispering)
Please, please, please! Please be
in here...

There is a beat of anticipation.

CU BAG INSIDE

James looks into the BAG, and sees his keys. Peace falls over James as he finds it. There is no longer any stress in his mind.

JAMES
(relieved, with a sigh)
OH THANK GOD!

The room has shifted from destruction, back to normal. All is right with the world and James is feeling good again. He goes back over to a MIRROR to make certain that his outfit is looking okay, he smiles. We see James' confidence back in him. He EXITS his bedroom with that confidence showing through him and walks downstairs into his living room. We sit in his living room for a few moments as he is LEAVING.

CUT TO:

4. EXT. OUTSIDE - CONTINUOUS

James walks OUT of his apartment and turns around to LOCK THE DOOR behind him. He fidgets through his keys to find the right one. James is still feeling good that he took a grasp on the stressful situation of finding his keys. Finally, the door is for sure locked. James take a beat to try and open it to double check that the door is in fact, locked. Confirmed, James turns back around and walks towards his CAR.

OTS SHOT OF JAMES WALKING TOWARDS HIS CAR (RIGHT)

We get halfay down the driveway towards his car where he starts to check his pockets

MEDIUM SHOT OF JAMES' HAND AS HE LOOKS FOR HIS WALLET.

There is a beat of shame, and silence as James stops in his tracks.

CUT TO:

5. MEDIUM CLOSE UP SHOT

James pauses as he realises he has forgotten yet another thing in his routine. He looks across his body as he goes through every single pocket meticulously. James is fuming at himself and starting to say mean comments towards himself.

JAMES

Ugh IDIOT! Can't even keep a
schedule in order. So embarssing...

The wallet was not found. James, saddened by this, turns around slower and walks back to his door. After this last comment, we see James' real side of things on how much he beats himself up over these little things. He gets to the door and we walk back with him to his living room.

James sets his things down by the door so they wont go out of place while he looks for his wallet. He starts to look underneath couch cushions, goes back upstairs to check a few places he was fully confident in, with no luck as of yet.

JAMES (VOICE OVER)

(worried, shaky)

Wasn't it... Like right over here?

James sighs. Almost defeated, he begins to stand back up from his search. He is almost compeltely drained from the breakdown before, yet he tries to keep his head up.

JAMES

I literally dont have time for
this. I'll just leave and hope I
dont get pulled over.

As he walks away towards the door, his wallet is peeking underneath a chair that is sitting nearby the doorway. Stunned, James almost walks by it before he sees it in his peripherals.

JAMES

(with shock)

Wha- What? My wallet!

With enthusiasm, he reaches for his wallet and happily grabs it and puts it in his pocket. He walks towards his things, adjusts them with his outfit and walks out the door with relief on his side.

JAMES

(happy, but slightly
irritated)

Finally, I've got all my stuff.
Let's get this shit overwith
already.

CUT TO:

James walks out the door and LOCKS it behind him. Again, he walks to his CAR and actually reaches it this time. He opens the car DOOR and we SIT INSIDE.

CUT TO:

6. INT. CAR INSIDE - DRIVER'S SEAT

James adjusts himself in the car and sets his things on the passenger side. First his bag, his wallet goes in front of it, then his PHONE.

He pauses before he sets his phone down and checks to see if he has missed any messages since he has been struggling to get his things. There is a missed text call from Macie and she left a voicemail.

JAMES

(slightly nervous,
Voiceover)

Uh oh. What did she say? Is she mad at me? I hope she's okay. What- what if she got in a wreck getting to our meetup spot? What if she never even left and is lying to me?

James is looking at his phone, and his mind is spiraling out of control. He cant seem to get a hold of his thoughts or anything today and it yet again looks like the world is crashing down on him. He unlocks his phone and opens the voicemail. James braces before pressing play. The car feels so small and the air is stiff.

MACIE

(voiceover, showing James' reactions)

Hey, James. I feel awful for saying this, but im not upset with you. I just wanted to call you and let you know that I can't make it to our coffee place today. I know we both were super excited about it, but I had something come up. I'm so so sorry, James. I'm sure we can plan this another time? Anyway, I love you. Bye.

She ends the voicemail softly, as if she was trying to talk to an animal. There is so much sadness in her voice as she speaks these words to James. It is clear in the voicemail that she knew how much this date meant to him.

James continues to hold the phone to his ear for a beat in shock. He slowly lowers it from his EAR and sets it in a CUPHOLDER.

7. MEDIUM CLOSE UP SHOT - CAR INSIDE - JAMES

James is in shock right now. There is almost an eternal pause as he struggles to figure out what to do next. It's as though his whole life was meant for this one moment and his plans just got torn to shreds. He slowly looks up into the camera as the camera pulls out.

SLOW ZOOM ON JAMES FROM OUTSIDE THE CAR

James' breathing starts to get faster and faster, then all of a sudden he shouts:

JAMES
You gotta be KIDDING ME!

CUT TO BLACK.

8. THE END.